

Custom Badge Header — Artwork Specification

This sheet describes how to prepare a graphic that prints as the header at the top of a name badge. The badges are produced on a Brother QL-820NWB thermal label printer, which prints **black on a white label only** — that drives most of the requirements below.

At a glance

File format	PNG with transparency (PNG-24). Not JPEG.
Canvas size	1200 × 300 px (or larger at the same ratio)
Aspect ratio	~4:1, wide / horizontal (3:1–5:1 is fine)
Colour	Black & white only — pure black #000000
Background	Transparent
Max file size	2 MB



Where the header lands on the badge

How your artwork is placed

The header sits in a short horizontal band across the top of the badge — about the top quarter of the badge by its full width. Your image is scaled to fit that band with its proportions kept intact; it is **never cropped or stretched**. A wide ~4:1 graphic fills the band nicely; a square or tall image is shrunk until its height fits and ends up small and centred, so please design it wide.

Black & white only — the most important part

The printer has **no colour and no grey**. Every pixel is turned into either solid black or nothing: the artwork is judged by brightness, and anything darker than roughly 30% brightness prints as black while everything lighter simply disappears. There is no shading, dithering, or partial ink. Design in pure black and white so what you see is what prints.

DO

- ✓ Solid black (#000000) shapes, icons, and text
- ✓ Transparent background
- ✓ Bold, chunky strokes and lettering
- ✓ Wide, horizontal lock-up (~4:1)
- ✓ Supply an all-black version of a colour logo

AVOID

- ✗ Colour, gradients, greys, tints, or opacity
- ✗ Drop shadows, glows, or soft/feathered edges
- ✗ JPEG — its background prints as a block
- ✗ Hairlines and tiny fine detail
- ✗ Square or tall artwork (prints small)

Deliver: a transparent PNG, 1200×300 px, pure black artwork, under 2 MB. If you also have a layered source (AI/SVG/PSD), please include it so the logo can be re-scaled later if needed.

Tip: to preview how a design will print, flatten it to pure black on white — if any element looks light grey, it will not print. Questions about sizing or the band? Reply to the email that sent you this sheet.